

Company Leave, PTO & Absence Management Policy

CATEGORY	Leave & Time Off	EFFECTIVE DATE	January 1, 2026	REVIEW CYCLE	Annual / Q4
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Article 1. Annual Paid Time Off (PTO) Entitlement & Accrual

Nexus Corporation recognizes the profound importance of rest, recreation, and mental rejuvenation for sustained professional excellence.

All full-time permanent team members are entitled to paid annual leave accrued on a monthly cadence throughout the calendar year.

Tenure Band	Annual PTO Entitlement	Monthly Accrual Rate
Years 0 – 3 (Standard Staff)	20 Business Days	1.67 Days / Completed Month
Years 4 – 6 (Senior Staff)	23 Business Days	1.92 Days / Completed Month
Years 7+ (Veteran Staff)	26 Business Days	2.17 Days / Completed Month

- Full-time permanent employees are entitled to 20 business days of paid annual leave (PTO) per calendar year, accruing monthly at 1.67 days.
- Part-time personnel accrue annual PTO on a pro-rated basis directly proportional to contracted weekly working hours.
- Employees may carry forward up to a maximum of 5 unused leave days into the following calendar year.
- Carryover days must be utilized before March 31 (end of Q1); unused carryover beyond 5 days is forfeited without financial payout.

REGULATORY MANDATE & REQUIREMENT:

Advance Notice Rule: Planned annual leave exceeding 3 consecutive days must be submitted through the Employee Portal at least 14 days in advance and approved by the direct manager.

Article 2. Sick Leave, Medical Documentation & Absence Tracking

Health and well-being are paramount. Employees must not report to work while experiencing contagious illnesses or acute symptoms.

Employees receive dedicated paid sick leave independent of their vacation allotment to recover from injury or illness.

Leave Classification	Annual Allotment	Documentation Mandate
Personal Illness / Recovery	10 Paid Days (allocated Jan 1)	Self-certification for days 1–3
Consecutive Medical Absence (>3d)	Drawn from Sick Bank	Mandatory Physician Certificate required
Dependent Care Medical Leave	Up to 5 Days from Sick Bank	Clinical appointment summary or doctor note

- Employees receive 10 paid sick days per calendar year, credited in full on January 1st (pro-rated upon hire).
- Medical absence exceeding 3 consecutive working days requires a certified medical practitioner notice submitted upon return.
- Sick leave covers acute illness, mental health recovery days, preventive health screenings, and routine dental/vision surgery.
- Unused sick days do not pay out upon resignation or termination.

REGULATORY MANDATE & REQUIREMENT:

Strict Privacy Guarantee: Medical certificates must confirm fitness to work and dates of incapacity; diagnostic details or private clinical notes are never required by HR.

Article 3. Parental, Maternity, Paternity & Primary Caregiver Leave

Welcoming a new child into a family is a monumental life event. Nexus Corporation provides top-tier parental leave benefits. Our policy provides comprehensive salary continuation regardless of gender, birth, adoption, or foster placement.

Caregiver Classification	Paid Leave Duration	Salary Continuation
Primary Caregiver (Birthing / Non-Birthing)	16 Weeks Paid Leave	100% Base Salary Continuation
Secondary Caregiver	6 Weeks Paid Leave	100% Base Salary Continuation
Adoption & Foster Placement	16 Weeks Paid Leave	100% Base Salary + \$3,000 legal subsidy

- Eligibility: Employees become eligible upon completing 6 consecutive months (180 days) of active service.
- Flexibility: Parental leave may be taken continuously or in two separate blocks within the first 12 months of birth or placement.
- Benefits Continuity: Health insurance, 401(k) matching, and equity vesting continue unabated during the entire leave window.

REGULATORY MANDATE & REQUIREMENT:

Notice Requirement: Expectant parents must notify People Operations at least 30 days prior to anticipated leave to coordinate transition plans and handover coverage.

Article 4. Bereavement, Compassionate Care & Civic Duties

Nexus Corporation stands firmly with employees facing personal tragedy or performing mandatory civic responsibilities. Compassionate leave is granted immediately upon notification to your manager without bureaucratic friction.

Leave Reason	Paid Duration	Eligible Relationships
Immediate Family Bereavement	Up to 5 Paid Business Days	Spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling
Extended Family Bereavement	Up to 2 Paid Business Days	Grandparent, grandchild, aunt, uncle, cousin
Mandated Jury Duty Summons	Up to 10 Paid Business Days	Summoned court juror or subpoenaed witness

- Additional unpaid bereavement or PTO may be combined with manager consent for international memorial travel.
- Civic Duty: Employees summoned for jury duty receive full base salary continuation for up to 10 working days.
- Voting Leave: Employees whose work hours do not permit 2 consecutive non-work hours while polls are open receive up to 2 hours paid leave.

REGULATORY MANDATE & REQUIREMENT:

A copy of the court summons or official jury panel attendance notice must be provided to People Operations within 5 days of court release.

Article 5. Unpaid Personal Leave & Educational Sabbaticals

In exceptional life circumstances where statutory leave or PTO is insufficient, employees may request unpaid sabbaticals. Leaves of absence may be authorized for personal health emergencies, family support, or formal educational endeavors.

Sabbatical Type	Maximum Duration	Prerequisites & Approvals
Personal Emergency Leave	Up to 60 Calendar Days	Manager and Head of HR Approval
Educational Sabbatical	Up to 90 Calendar Days	Minimum 24 months tenure & VP Approval
Statutory FMLA Unpaid Leave	Up to 12 Weeks (Job Protected)	1,250 hours worked over past 12 months

- Approval is discretionary and evaluated against team operational capacity and candidate performance standing.
- Health benefits: The employee may elect to maintain group health benefits by paying the standard employee share of premiums.
- Return to work: Nexus guarantees restoration to the same or equivalent position upon scheduled return.

REGULATORY MANDATE & REQUIREMENT:

Employees failing to return on the mutually agreed resumption date without documented extension will be deemed to have voluntarily resigned.

Article 6. Statutory Entitlements, Holiday Schedule & Absence Compliance

Nexus Corporation observes all federally declared public holidays along with flexible cultural observance days. Unexcused absences undermine team productivity and are subject to progressive disciplinary enforcement.

Holiday / Absence Category	Allotment	Operational Guideline
Statutory Public Holidays	11 Fixed Days / Year	Offices closed; systems monitored by on-call rota
Floating Cultural Holidays	2 Paid Days / Year	Elected individually for personal cultural observance
Unexcused Absence (No Call/No Show)	0 Days	Disciplinary written warning on day 1

- Floating holidays must be taken within the calendar year and do not carry over or pay out upon departure.
- Job Abandonment: An absence of 3 consecutive working days without communication (No Call / No Show) constitutes voluntary job abandonment.
- Disputes regarding leave balances should be logged via a ticket in the Employee Portal to People Operations.

REGULATORY MANDATE & REQUIREMENT:

All leave requests and approvals must be formally recorded in the portal; informal verbal agreements outside the system are non-binding.